

Ravi Parthasarathy, chairman and managing director, IL&FS: Our theme this year is skill set upgradation for inclusive growth. We are very good in producing IITs and IIMs. The problem is at the lower-end. We have a very large workforce. But 93 per cent of it is in the informal sector. We are working on pilot projects with the Rural Development Ministry for skill development of people below the poverty line and also with the textiles industry. We need to do more. We need to fill this gap through public-private partnerships.

Chawla: Maj Gen Khanduri, you are the first-timer chief minister but senior in terms of experience. Do you believe in good politics or good economics?

Major General (retd) B.C. Khanduri, chief minister, Uttarakhand: The finance minister says the states are rich. My state has Rs 16,000 crore of debt, my budget is Rs 4,000 crore and we pay an interest of Rs 500 crore. But I do not know where this money is.

Chawla: We have got a chief minister who represents Mumbai, which collects 48 per cent of revenue for the country and his farmers are committing suicide.

Vilasrao Deshmukh, chief minister, Maharashtra: Maharashtra is growing at between 8 and 9 per cent and we hope it will touch 10 per cent. We are concentrating on industry and service sector. These two sectors will definitely contribute to Maharashtra's growth reaching the 10 per cent level. But the basic need of agriculture is there, because 70 per cent of the people are still dependent on it. Unless

"The finance minister says states have money. Where is it? Our debt is Rs 16,000 crore and we pay Rs 500 crore in interest."

B.C. KHANDURI
CHIEF MINISTER, UTTARAKHAND



"Because of the special status given to some states, investment has fled our state. We should be compensated for this."

DIGAMBAR KAMAT
CHIEF MINISTER, GOA

"Despite our mineral wealth we suffered because of faulty policies. Now we have signed MoUs worth Rs 2,50,000 crore."

K.V. SINGH DEO
URBAN DEVELOPMENT MINISTER, ORISSA



and until we reduce the burden on agriculture, it cannot be sustainable. For that, we have to give some alternate jobs, and that can only be created through industrialisation and service sector. For that, we need education.

Chawla: Shri Modi, please tell us what can be done in a state where people themselves are delivering justice.

Sushil Kumar Modi, deputy chief minister, Bihar: I feel the Centre should suspend all the poverty alleviation schemes and deposit money in the accounts of the poor directly. There is so much of corruption and so much of leakage. The schemes have failed to uplift the poor.

Chawla: Sheilaji, people say Rs 20,000 crore spent on Metro for the middle-class could have been spent in a better way.

Sheila Dikshit, chief minister, Delhi: I do not agree with you. I think transport is as important for the common man as power is. It is not that we can have one at the cost of the other. Where I do agree with you that governance systems have become outdated. We need to respond faster.

Virbhadra Singh, chief minister, Himachal Pradesh: I feel today one of the burning problems is that of unemployment. Over the years employment opportunities have increased but there is a mismatch. On national policies, there has to be some consensus among political parties.

Chawla: Mr Singh Deo, Orissa is an under-developed state. You have money, as Mr Chidambaram claims, but you are not able to spend it.

K.V. Singh Deo, minister for urban development, Orissa: We started off in 1999-2000 with a deficit budget of Rs 2,574 crore, and today we have revenue surplus of Rs 1,045 crore. This has been achieved by a shift in the policies that we engineered.

Chawla: We don't have a consensus in the house but there is clearly concern over the lack of inclusive growth.

"Unless we have inclusive growth, there can be no growth. There are certain issues on which we need a national consensus."

VILASRAO DESHMUKH
CHIEF MINISTER, MAHARASHTRA



"We want more educational institutions in the rural areas or there will be great discrimination."

TARUN GOGOI
CHIEF MINISTER, ASSAM

